everything from China, I now want to have three suppliers. That is how resilience is built. It is going to take longer. There are going to be more stops, and more capacity will be needed. It is going to take time to build that capacity. We have just emerged from a zero interest rate era to a 6% cost.

Q: What lessons from diversification and acquisitions are shaping DP World's operations now?
A: I am glad we did what we did. We are diversified. We are in 80 different countries. First, we changed from being a siloed port operating company to a connected one. Then we realised that the real owners of cargo want to see integrated supply chain solutions. So, you have to play the supply chain domestically, to connect the country first from within and then be able to connect the country with the rest of your network. That is what we are doing.

How do you take Indian companies into Africa? None of these places are easy to do business. So we developed the capability to distribute and house Indian products in Africa by building market access and ports. We do the same thing in Latin America. What we learned from COVID was that the length of the supply chain was a risk. China shut down. Singapore shut down. India remained operational. If I was totally dependent on those two countries, my business would have shut down. Our vision and mission is resilient connectivity.

Q: Does India have an opportunity to become a transshipment hub? What would it take?
A: I don't know what you exactly mean by transshipment. You need passage for cargo. Transshipment in itself is a meaningless thing. The most efficient way to move goods is from point of origin to point of destination direct, without stoppages. The largest trade in the world is inter-Asia. It may change from China to the rest of the world, to China plus Vietnam, plus Thailand, plus Malaysia, plus India to the rest of the world. India can grab a large share now. If you let it go now, somebody else will take it.

Q: Is India recognising the opportunity, and removing bottlenecks?
A: One hears it consistently from powers that be here that India wants to become a manufacturing base for the world. I think supply chain infrastructure in the country, whether it is rail, road or shipping, has grown.

Q: After COVID, India was expected to benefit from 'China plus one', but countries such as Vietnam also benefited. Is the idea still relevant?
A: Diversification from China is a brutal reality. Let us face it, it is not easy to do that. American capital built China. But if they think China is a monster today, they have built it. Now, why is that capital not coming into India? Why is Indian industry not doing what it should be doing?

Q: What should Indian industry be doing?
A: How much of new investment have they made in India?

Q: Some in the next generation of Indian business families prefer managing family offices... Is the problem risk aversion or a limited pool of capital?
A:. When I meet a lot of successful industrialists I ask them, 'Why don't you create global institutions that have Indian origin?' I seem to get the response that the return on capital in India is the highest in any part of the world, so why would I bother? On the other hand, India is still under-invested. The two don't make sense together.

If I can take a short-term punt and ride on the Indian tiger as industry doubles in value and triples in value, I just put in money, and when I think I have had enough of a return, I get out. I don't have to go through the pain of setting up a business in India. We succumbed to the financial interests of the world - let me come and play the Indian growth story, without investing long-term in India.

"There is no order. World trade is a subset of the world order. What we are going through right now is a broken world order"